

Individual Reflection

QSR Location Health Index — Employer Project with VP Analytics (Agency 5)

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Analysis of group strengths and weaknesses

As a team, we divided the work along the analytical pipeline: teammates led stages such as data preparation, business classification, and the written report and slide design, while I focused on the EDA, the NLP-based aspect-level sentiment analysis, building the Location Health Index scoring system, and the HTML interactive operator's dashboard. Our clearest challenge was getting the QSR business classification right. During my EDA, I identified outliers and false-positive QSR businesses that had slipped through the first filter, and flagged it to the team twice before the classification held up. As a group, we responded well once flagged, adjusting the filter and re-running the affected stages rather than pressing ahead regardless. We also kept a habit of tracking one another's progress and updating each other regularly, which kept everyone aligned as the analysis evolved.

Analysis of individual strengths and weaknesses

My strongest contribution was building the technical core of the project: the NLP-based aspect-sentiment model, the Location Health Index scoring system, and the HTML interactive dashboard, then making sure the team understood it properly. I regularly updated everyone on my progress and reasoning, not just outputs, so teammates writing the report and presentation could build on accurate understanding rather than guesswork. This mattered most once feedback arrived. After Assignment 2, our tutor's feedback centred almost entirely on the scorecard I had built, praising the weighted health score and the worked example of a struggling outlet, while asking us to justify the weighting more clearly and show a healthy outlet too. I took that as feedback on my own work and acted on it directly, though I could have pushed for that justification earlier, before it was flagged.

Summary of individual contributions and key highlights

The clearest example of my role came during EDA, when I identified outliers and false-positive QSR businesses that had slipped through our first classification filter. Rather than let it pass, I flagged it to the team, and had to raise it twice before we adjusted the filter and re-ran the affected stages. That decision meant our final population of 19,154 businesses was one we could actually stand behind, rather than one quietly carrying errors nobody had noticed. It was a small, unglamorous check, but it protected the credibility of everything the rest of the team built on top of it afterwards.

Suggestions for future improvements

Going forward, I want to build in structured checks earlier, rather than catching inconsistencies close to the deadline. On more than one occasion late in this project, a chart, a figure, or a methodology note had fallen out of sync with an updated analysis, simply because nobody had a routine for re-checking older material

once something changed upstream. I also learned to plan around constraints outside our control. The Snowflake environment was provided and configured by the course, with role restrictions and credit limits we had no say over, and we lost time more than once when access dropped unexpectedly. I raised these issues with the course team as soon as they appeared, and they worked to resolve it, but time was still lost while access was restored. Next time, I would build slack into the schedule for that kind of platform interruption, so a delay outside our control puts less pressure on the rest of the timeline.